



RVSR JOB AID

Appropriate VA Form by Benefit

M21-1, III.ii.i2.B.1.b

Effective March 24, 2015, VA will only recognize compensation, pension, survivors, and related claims if they are submitted on the required standard forms. The table below provides guidance on the correct VA form to use based on the type of benefit sought by the claimant.

If the benefit sought is...	Then the prescribed form is VA Form...
Service connection (SC) (original)	• 21-526 • 21-526c for Benefits Delivery at Discharge (BDD) or Quick Start (QS) claims • 21-526EZ, or • 21-0819 for IDES claims.
SC (new or reopened)	• 21-526 • 21-526b, Veterans Supplemental Claim for Compensation • 21-526c for BDD or QS claims • 21-526EZ, or • 21-0819 for IDES claims.
Increased evaluation or a claim for a permanent and total (P&T) rating	• 21-526 • 21-526b • 21-526c for BDD or QS claims • 21-526EZ, or • 21-0819 for IDES claims.
temporary total disability rating (paragraph 29 and 30 benefits)	• 21-526 • 21-526b, or • 21-526EZ. Note: Hospitalization reports from VA or military treatment facilities will be accepted as a prescribed form for paragraph 29 and 30 benefits.
total disability rating based on individual unemployability (TDIU)	• 21-8940, Veteran's Application for Increased Compensation Based on Unemployability.



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	TDIU can also be claimed on any of the following VA Forms • 21-526 • 21-526b • 21-526c for BDD or QS claims, or • 21-526EZ.
child incapable of self-support benefits	• 21-526 • 21-526b • 21-526EZ • 21-686c, Declaration of Status of Dependents • 21-527 • 21-527EZ • 21-534, Application for Dependency and Indemnity Compensation, Death Pension and Accrued Benefits by a Surviving Spouse or Child (Including Death Compensation if Applicable), or • 21-534a, Application for Dependency and Indemnity Compensation by a Surviving Spouse or Child - In-Service Death Only. Note: Information about a child incapable of self-support submitted by a Veteran on VA Form 21-0538, Status of Dependents Questionnaire, will be accepted as a claim to add the dependent(s) to the Veteran's award.
Veterans Pension (original)	• 21-526, or • 21-527EZ.
Veterans Pension (new)	• 21-526 • 21-527, or • 21-527EZ. • VA Form 21-0516-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Veteran with No Children) • VA Form 21-0517-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Veteran with Children)



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dependency and indemnity compensation (DIC), Survivors Pension and accrued benefits (new or reopened, as applicable)	• 21-534 • 21-534a • 21-534EZ, Application for DIC, Death Pension, and/or Accrued Benefits • 21-535, Application for Dependency and Indemnity Compensation by Parent(s) (Including Accrued Benefits and Death Compensation when Applicable), • 21-601, Application for Accrued Amounts Due A Deceased Beneficiary, for accrued benefits only • VA Form 21-0518-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Surviving Spouse With No Children) • VA Form 21-0519S-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Surviving Spouse With Children) • VA Form 21-0519C-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Child or Children), or • VA Form 21-0514-1, DIC Parent's Eligibility Verification Report.
income adjustments for running pension awards or to supplement original applications (income/asset/net worth, liberalized legislation)	• VA Form 21-0512S-1, Old Law and Section 306 Eligibility Verification Report (Surviving Spouse) • VA Form 21-0512V-1, Old Law and Section 306 Eligibility Verification Report (Veteran) • VA Form 21-0513-1, Old Law and Section 306 Eligibility Verification Report (Children Only) • VA Form 21-0514-1, DIC Parent's Eligibility Verification Report • VA Form 21-0516-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Veteran with No Children) • VA Form 21-0517-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Veteran with Children)



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	• VA Form 21-0518-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Surviving Spouse With No Children) • VA Form 21-0519C-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Child or Children) • VA Form 21-0519S-1, Pension Eligibility Verification Report (Surviving Spouse With Children) • VA Form 21P-8416, Medical Expense Report • VA Form 21P-8416b, Report of Medical, Legal, and Other Expenses Incident to Recovery for Injury or Death • VA Form 21-0571, Application For Exclusion Of Children's Income • VA Form 21-8049, Request for Details of Expenses • VA Form 21P-4165, Pension Claim Questionnaire for Farm Income, and • VA Form 21-4185, Report of Income from Property or Business Exception: VA does not require beneficiaries to use a specific form to report a change in income that will result in a decrease in benefits. A beneficiary may report such changes • in writing • by telephone, e-mail, or fax, or • through eBenefits.
burial benefits	• 21P-530, Application for Burial Benefits.
FOR GUIDANCE specialty adapted housing (SAH) or special housing adaptation (SHA)	• 26-4555, Application in Acquiring Specially Adapted Housing or Special Home Adaptation Grant, and • 26-4555c, Veteran/Service member's Supplemental Application for Assistance in Acquiring Specially Adapted Housing. SAH/SHA can also be filed on any of the following VA Forms: • 21-526



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	• 21-526b, or • 21-526EZ. Important: SAH/SHA claims and supplemental benefits require • VA Form 26-4555 for the award of benefits and can be used as a standalone form for claims, or • VA Form 26-4555c, for the award of supplemental benefits. The form can also be used as a standalone claims form.
auto allowance	• 21-4502, Application for Automobile or Other Conveyance and Adaptive Equipment. Auto allowance can also be filed on any of the following VA Forms • 21-526 • 21-526b, or • 21-526EZ. Important: VA Form 21-4502 is required for the award of benefits and can be used as a standalone form for auto allowance claims.
special monthly compensation (SMC) for housebound/aid and attendance (A&A) including spousal A&A	• 21-526 • 21-526b • 21-526EZ, or • 21-2680, Examination for Housebound Status or Permanent Need for Regular Aid and Attendance. Reference: For more information on reviewing VA Form 21-2680 to identify the benefit sought, see M21-1, Part III, Subpart ii, 2.B.1.f and g.
spina bifida	• 21-0304, Application for Benefits for Certain Children with Disabilities Born of Vietnam and Certain Korea Service Veterans.
apportionment	• 21-0788, Information Regarding Apportionment of Beneficiary's Award.



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dependents	• 21-526 • 21-527 (pension only) • 21-527EZ (pension only) • 21-686c • 21-674, Request for Approval of School Attendance, (school children over 18 only), or • 21P-509, Statement of Dependency of Parent(s), (for dependent parent(s) only) • VA Form 21-4170, Statement of Marital History (for adding a spouse based on a common-law marriage), or • VA Form 21-0538, Status of Dependents Questionnaire (if submitted as part of the verification process described in M21-1, Part III, Subpart iii, 5.K. Important: A Veteran may use VA Form 21-0538, to initiate the process of adding a spouse to his/her award. However, this form contains no sections wherein the Veteran may provide his/her marital history or the marital history of his/her spouse. Without this information, VA cannot determine whether the Veteran and his/her spouse are free to marry. Accordingly, a Veteran in this case must ultimately provide the information contained in VA Form 21-686c in addition to the VA Form 21-0538. In accordance with M21-1, Part III, Subpart iii, 5.A.4.g
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Notes:

- There is no standard form requirement for claims for substitution. Under 38 CFR 3.1010, a claim for substitution does not require a standard form. It may be submitted on VA Form 21-0847, Request for Substitution of Claimant upon Death of Claimant, but this form is not required for a claim for substitution.
- VA Form 21-8940 is not an acceptable standard form for a claim for increase. However, as a part of adjudication of the TDIU issue, entitlement to an increased evaluation of the service-connected (SC) disabilities must be considered. For



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more information on considering entitlement to an increased evaluation of SC disabilities when considering claims for TDIU, see M21-1, Part IV, Subpart ii, 2.F.2.h.

- In accordance with M21-1, Part III, Subpart iii, 5.A.4.d, a specific form is not needed to remove a dependent from an award.

FOR GUIDANCE ONLY